Big Small World

Assessment 2

Kira Zakirov

A00153068

Design Studio 1 - (DSO102)

Story Behind the Sculpture: *Big Small World*

The idea behind *Big Small World* came from observing how easily we overlook the tiny things around us—like insects, leaves, or textures in nature—that actually hold incredible meaning. I wanted to capture that contrast: something physically small, but emotionally expansive.

The dragonfly-like creature in my sculpture represents fragility, curiosity, and hidden strength. It belongs to a miniature world that feels vast when we pay attention, a place where the tiniest wing or branch carries its own weight and purpose. I used delicate materials—clay, ribbon, and natural wood—not just for their texture, but to emphasize the balance between vulnerability and resilience.

This piece invites the viewer to pause and reflect on the quieter parts of life, to find wonder in stillness. In a world that often values what's big and loud, *Big Small World* is about celebrating the subtle and the small—reminding us that even the gentlest presence can hold power.

"The species and the genus are always the work of nature [i.e. specially created]; the variety mostly that of circumstance; the class and the order are the work of nature and art." (Carl Linnaeus Quote, 2025)

Digital representation

(Kowit Phangkee, 2025)

(County, 2019)

(*Free Vectors | Dragonfly Face*, 2025)

(*Dragonflies of Manitoba*, n.d.)

Moodborad

Moodboard

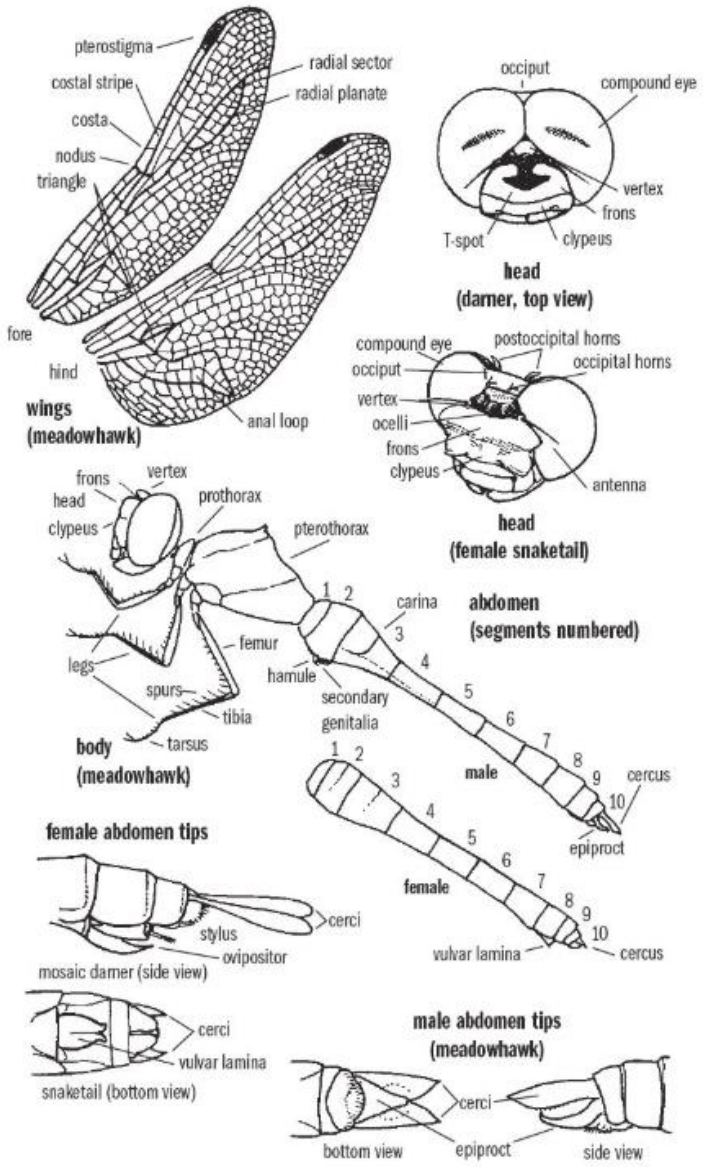
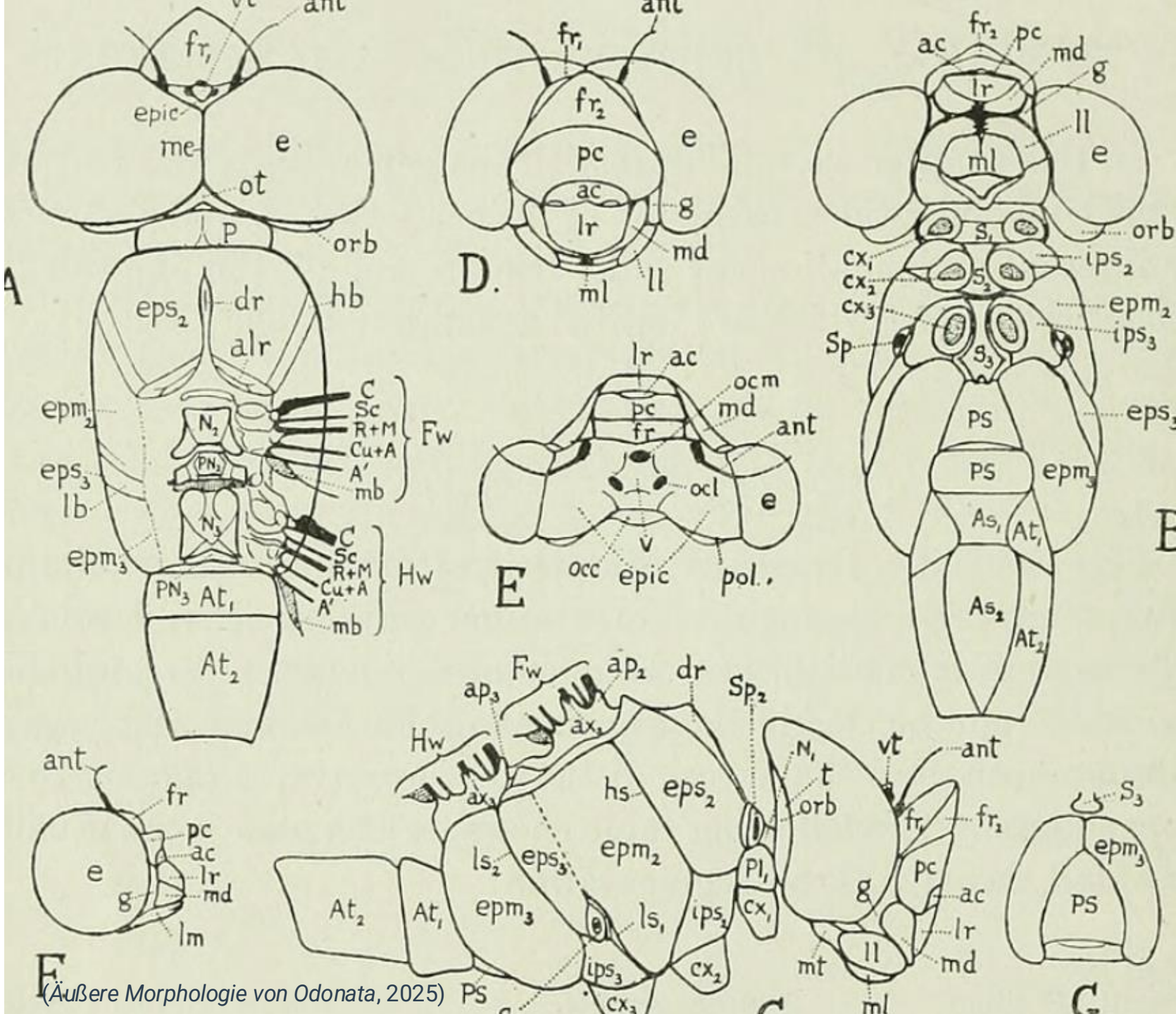


Figure 1. Dragonfly anatomy.

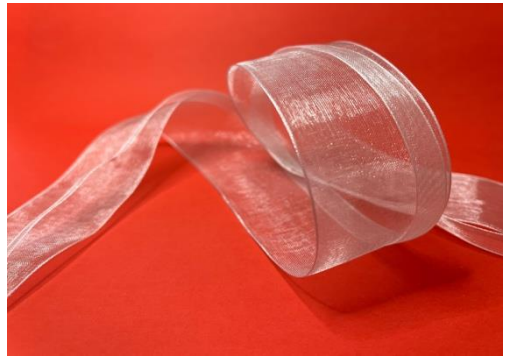
(*Dragonfly Anatomy*, 2025)



(*Äußere Morphologie von Odonata*, 2025)

Material Choice

Wire (Structure):
Lightweight, durable, and reusable
Offers strong internal support without relying on plastics



Satin Ribbon (Wings):
Fabric-based alternative to plastic
Lightweight, expressive, and low-impact in production

Air-dry Clay (Head & Body):
Natural, biodegradable material
Ideal for eco-conscious sculpting with minimal environmental impact

Succulent Branch (Tail):
Reused organic material
Reduces waste and adds natural character to the sculpture

Reflecting on My Design Journey

This project marked a unique and rewarding step in my creative development. While the final sculpture may appear delicate and simple, the design process behind it was filled with experimentation, problem-solving, and unexpected lessons.

Initially, I was driven by a clear vision: I wanted to combine organic and manmade materials to create something that felt both natural and otherworldly. Choosing to use clay as the base material allowed for expressive shaping, but it also came with limitations I had not anticipated. For example, sculpting fine details like small limbs required more structural support than I expected. This led me to integrate wire into the framework, which turned out to be one of the most effective decisions. It made the sculpture more stable and allowed for subtle adjustments throughout the process.

One of the more experimental parts of the design was integrating non-traditional elements such as a succulent branch for the tail and satin ribbon for the wings. These materials offered interesting contrasts in texture and movement, but also presented challenges in attachment and balance. I had to learn to adapt tools and techniques to suit each material and accept that not everything would go as planned.

Perhaps the most important takeaway from this project was learning to embrace imperfection and unpredictability. Sometimes materials reacted differently than I expected or dried in unexpected ways—but instead of seeing that as failure, I started to see it as part of the piece's character. I also gained a greater appreciation for combining aesthetic intention with ethical decision-making, particularly in my material choices. Overall, this project taught me to be more flexible, resourceful, and thoughtful in both planning and making.

References

Carl Linnaeus Quote. (2025). A-Z Quotes. https://www.azquotes.com/quote/538395

Images References

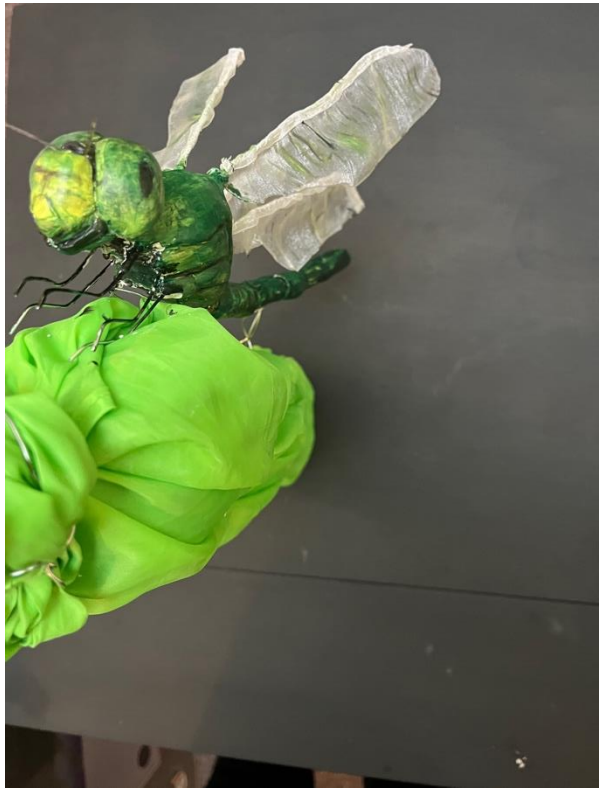
Äußere Morphologie von Odonata. (2025, May 5). *WikiBrief.org*. https://german.wikibrief.org/wiki/External_morphology_of_Odonata

County, Forest Preserve District of DuPage. (2019, August 12). *Feeding habits of daring dragonflies*. https://www.dupageforest.org/blog/daring-dragonflies

Dragonflies of Manitoba. (n.d.). *NatureNorth.com*. http://www.naturenorth.com/dragonfly/DOM/Page08_Flight.html

Dragonfly anatomy. (2025). *Pinterest*. https://au.pinterest.com/pin/dragonfly-anatomy--380765343470125989/

Free Vectors | Dragonfly face. (2025). *Ac-Illust.com*. https://ac-illust.com/clip-art/25813531

Phangkee, K. (2025). *Chamomile flower field: Camomile in the nature. Field of camomiles at sunny day at nature. Camomile daisy flowers in summer day. Chamomile flowers field wide background in sun light*. *Vecteezy*. https://www.vecteezy.com/free-photos/nature-background

Thank you!